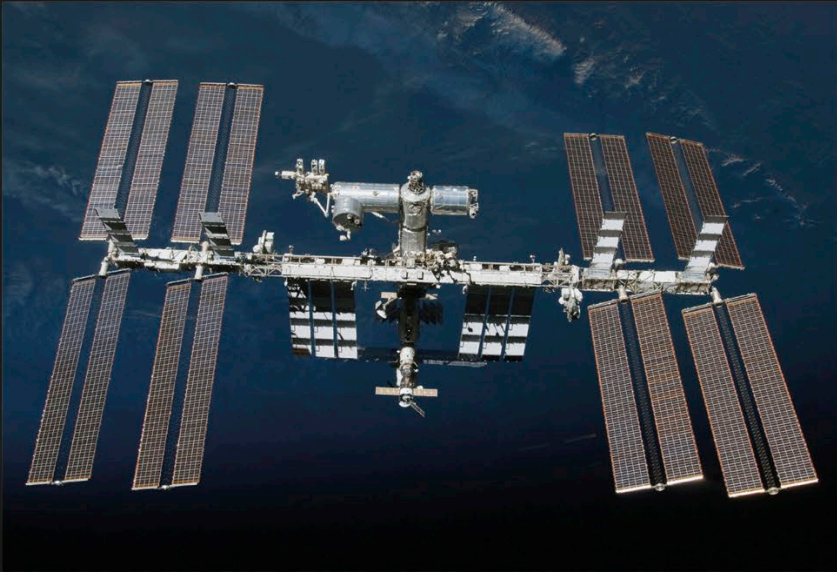
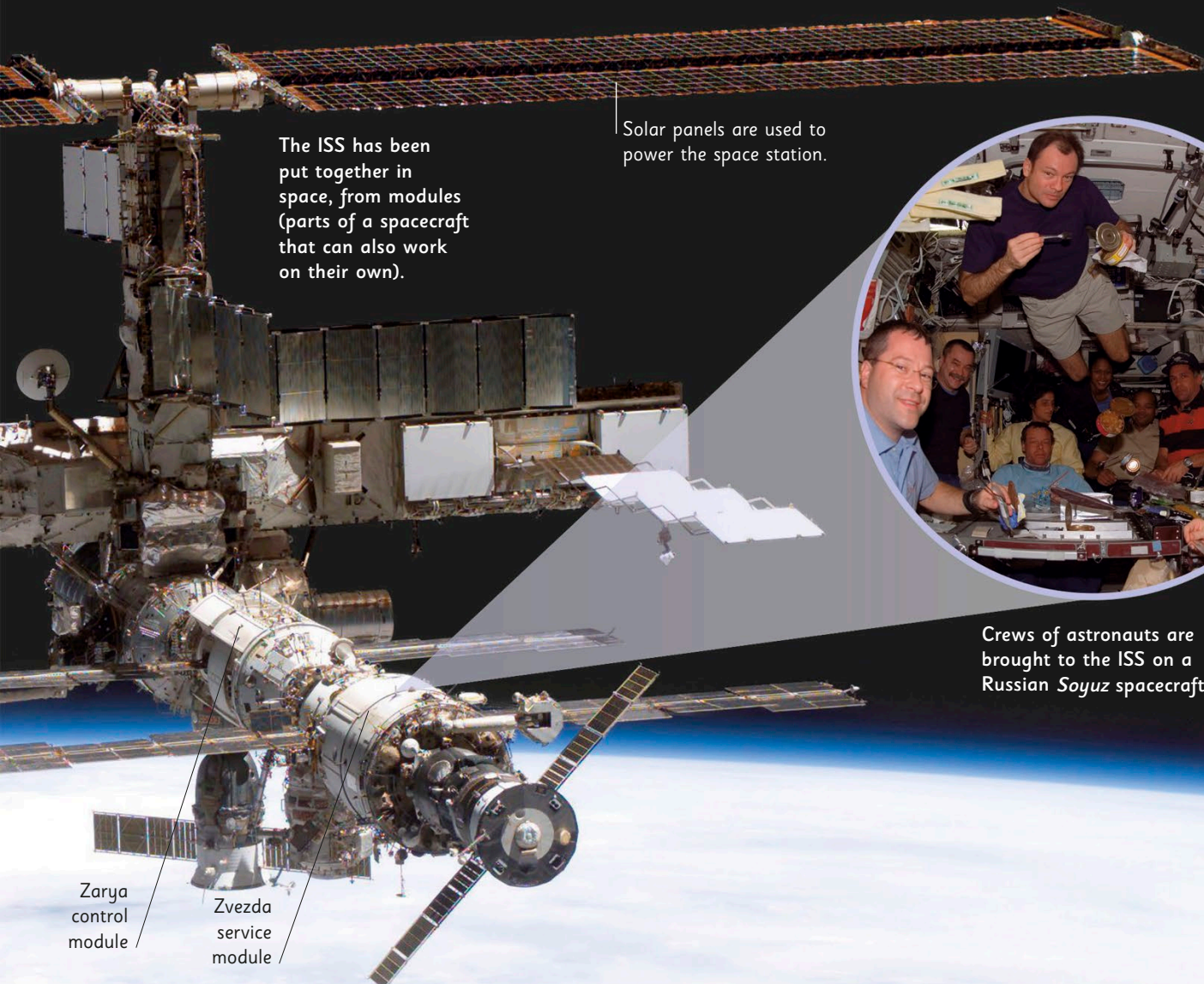




The ISS is constantly growing, as new parts are added. This photograph was taken in 2010.

What is a space station?

It's a space laboratory that orbits the Earth, operated by crews of astronauts who take turns living and working on it. Each crew stays for several weeks or months. Occasionally, an astronaut has stayed a whole year!



The ISS has been put together in space, from modules (parts of a spacecraft that can also work on their own).

Solar panels are used to power the space station.



Crews of astronauts are brought to the ISS on a Russian *Soyuz* spacecraft.

Zarya
control
module

Zvezda
service
module